



You tap out a drum beat using the PSP's buttons and control your tribal warriors to execute manoeuvres'. No game comes close to being this addictive!

and completely tossing them around to come out with a whole new approach to gaming.

The story goes that the Patapon were a flourishing people until they were defeated by the evil Zigoton Empire. In the game, you play the role of their god and use your war drums to direct the tribe to the end of the world in search of 'IT' – a mystical object that promises to solve all their troubles.

As was suggested, Patapon is a 'rhythm-based' game. Each button of the PSP has a different beat assigned to it and the combination of these beats will have you composing rhythms. That's right, you will be making music to guide your soldiers!

The game slowly introduces different types of rhythms and the action associated with them. The drum beats are accompanied by your tribe chanting 'Pata-pata-pata-pon', creating a unique blend of vocal harmony and drums. Be warned, though, that these rhythms are going to get stuck in your head for a really long time!

Different rhythms make them perform different tasks and it can get quite mesmerising. At first, controlling a rhythm while also devising strategies to defeat your enemy can be a bit of a challenge in multi-tasking. However, by the fifth or eighth level, you should get used to the balance and be tapping your way to new attacks like a pro.

Timing your attacks well and getting them in a combo-like sequence will activate the Fever Mode, with your tribe rapidly advancing across the 2D battlefield. The visuals are quite cool, with a silhouette-like style that is backed by bright colours. The environments of each level are an integral part of the game, as desert sands will slow down your infantry while strong winds send your arrows astray.

After completing each of the 30

